

Press Start to Continue: A Thematic Analysis of the Iterative Process of Hardcore Players with Disabilities Adapting to Gameplay Difficulties

Eunbyul Park*
Games and Life Lab, Graduate School
of Metaverse
Korea Advanced Institute of Science
and Technology
Daejeon, Republic of Korea
silverstar@kaist.ac.kr

Jihun Chae*
Games and Life Lab, Graduate School
of Culture Technology
Korea Advanced Institute of Science
and Technology
Daejeon, Republic of Korea
chaejihun@kaist.ac.kr

Karam Eum
Games and Life Lab, Graduate School
of Culture Technology
Korea Advanced Institute of Science
and Technology
Daejeon, Republic of Korea
karam.eum@kaist.ac.kr

Eunhye Choi
Games and Life Lab, Graduate School
of Metaverse
Korea Advanced Institute of Science
and Technology
Daejeon, Republic of Korea
eunhye0323@kaist.ac.kr

Hyunyoung Oh
Games and Life Lab, Graduate School
of Culture Technology
Korea Advanced Institute of Science
and Technology
Daejeon, Republic of Korea
microtrombo@kaist.ac.kr

Young Yim Doh
Games and Life Lab, Graduate School
of Culture Technology
Korea Advanced Institute of Science
and Technology
Daejeon, Republic of Korea
yydoh@kaist.ac.kr

Abstract

Playing video games can empower players with disabilities by providing them opportunities for connection, achievement, and cultural participation. However, as they continue playing, they need to devise alternative ways to access inaccessible game goals and manage social demands from multiplayer games. This study investigated how players with disabilities navigate these difficulties by analyzing interviews with five hardcore players with disabilities. The findings emphasize the critical role of available resources, including accessibility features, inclusive design supporting experimentation, and robust community support in enabling players to continue playing. To do so, players adapt to game difficulties through an iterative process of employing coping strategies using available resources. The findings highlight the importance of game environment, social, and cultural resources in supporting participants' continued gameplay and provide related insights.

CCS Concepts

• **Human-centered computing** → **Empirical studies in accessibility**; • **Social and professional topics** → **People with disabilities**; • **Applied computing** → **Computer games**.

*Both first authors contributed equally to this research.

Permission to make digital or hard copies of all or part of this work for personal or classroom use is granted without fee provided that copies are not made or distributed for profit or commercial advantage and that copies bear this notice and the full citation on the first page. Copyrights for third-party components of this work must be honored. For all other uses, contact the owner/author(s).

CHI EA '25, Yokohama, Japan

© 2025 Copyright held by the owner/author(s).

ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-1395-8/25/04

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3719723>

Keywords

Game Accessibility, Players with Disabilities, Inclusive Game Design

ACM Reference Format:

Eunbyul Park, Jihun Chae, Karam Eum, Eunhye Choi, Hyunyoung Oh, and Young Yim Doh. 2025. Press Start to Continue: A Thematic Analysis of the Iterative Process of Hardcore Players with Disabilities Adapting to Gameplay Difficulties. In *Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '25)*, April 26–May 01, 2025, Yokohama, Japan. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 7 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3719723>

1 Introduction

Video games have become a significant cultural phenomenon, providing opportunities for digital participation, identity formation, and community building. They not only reflect societal patterns but also shape social interactions, serving as a lens to understand contemporary culture [14]. Despite the inclusive potential of gaming, players with disabilities often face difficulties that limit their ability to fully engage in gameplay [6]. Nevertheless, many players with disabilities demonstrate remarkable resilience, employing innovative coping strategies and making use of their resources to adapt and remain active contributors within gaming communities.

While existing research on game accessibility primarily focuses on identifying difficulties or developing technical solutions, less attention has been given to the adaptive processes players with disabilities undertake to sustain their engagement. Questions about what enables long-term gameplay and why some players persist while others disengage remain underexplored. In this study, we define difficulties as player-perceived difficulties to completing game tasks. These difficulties may stem from intentional design features or unintended factors such as social pressures or environmental

Table 1: Participant Profiles. This table presents data from five participants with disabilities, including their age, gender, gaming preferences (both favorite and frequently played games), and specific details about their disabilities.

Participant	Gender	Age Range	Favorite Game (Genre)	Frequently Playing Game (Genre)	Types of Disabilities	Details
P1	Male	25-29	League of Legends (MOBA)	League of Legends (MOBA)	Hard of Hearing with Speech Disability	The participant can perceive sounds but struggles with distinguishing speech clearly and has difficulty articulating specific sounds or words, with occasional mispronunciations in certain contexts.
P2	Male	20-24	League of Legends (MOBA)	League of Legends (MOBA)	Hard of Hearing	The participant has partial hearing loss in one ear and uses a cochlear implant to assist with sound perception.
P3	Male	30-34	Lost Ark (MMORPG)	Teamfight Tactics (Auto Battler)	Motor Disability	The participant can use only specific fingers on both hands and uses a wheelchair for mobility.
P4	Female	35-39	Lost Ark (MMORPG)	Trickcal Re:VIVE (Mobile Collectible Role-Playing Game)	Hard of Hearing	The participant has severe hearing loss in both ears, relies on hearing aids to perceive sound, can sense vibrations when not using the aids, and can lipread for communication.
P5	Male	35-39	Lost Ark (MMORPG)	Lost Ark (MMORPG)	Visual Disability	The participant has low vision caused by a combination of conditions, including astigmatism, dim vision, blurry vision, sensitivity to light (glare), clouded vision, and difficulty seeing in both bright and dark environments.

Note: MOBA stands for Multiplayer Online Battle Arena, and MMORPG stands for Massively Multiplayer Online Role-Playing Game.

constraints. Unlike "challenge", which reflects game design, or "competency", tied to player skill, difficulty is subjective and shaped by individual experiences and context [19].

This study addresses key gaps in the current literature by focusing on the experiences of hardcore players with disabilities, who invest significant time in gaming, engage with a diverse range of games, and develop deep knowledge of game mechanics [12]. Their sustained commitment makes them a valuable group for studying how players adapt to overcome difficulties, as they have continuously refined their coping strategies over time. This ongoing process involves iterative trial and error, where players adjust their strategies, access various resources, and enhance their self-knowledge. By examining these adaptive mechanisms, this study aims to provide foundational knowledge derived from players' lived experiences to inform the design of AI-driven accessibility solutions. This includes understanding the range of resources players use and the personalized coping strategies they develop through adaptive game settings and accessibility features. These findings will serve as the foundation for developing AI-driven accessibility solutions that assist players with disabilities in overcoming in-game difficulties, forming the basis for our future research.

The current research is guided by the following questions:

- (1) What difficulties do hardcore players with disabilities face, and how do they cope with these difficulties?
- (2) How do the adaptive processes differ between players who continue playing and those who disengage or transfer to other games?

2 Related Work

2.1 Difficulties in Continued Gameplay Experienced by Players with Disabilities

For players with disabilities, video games offer more than entertainment—they provide opportunities for independence, autonomy, and meaningful social interactions [6]. Games serve as spaces for exploring new experiences, maintaining social connections, and practicing interactions in low-pressure environments [3, 8, 13]. These benefits underscore the critical importance of accessibility and inclusivity in game design.

Despite these advantages, mainstream video games often fail to address the accessibility needs of players with disabilities. Limited customization options and features designed for specific disabilities frequently hinder engagement [11]. Players face diverse difficulties related to their physical, sensory, or cognitive abilities. These include difficulties with repetitive inputs, precise motor control, recognizing auditory cues, navigating visually complex interfaces, and understanding intricate game mechanics or poorly designed tutorials [16]. The lack of compatibility with assistive technologies further compounds these difficulties, restricting players' ability to fully engage with games. While prior research highlights the importance of accessibility-focused game design [2, 10], these persistent difficulties highlight the need for more inclusive and adaptive gaming environments that address the diverse needs of players with disabilities.

Studies that investigated the adaptive process of players with disabilities reported accessibility difficulties and adaptations examined within specific contexts, focusing on strategies used by particular disability populations, such as navigation strategies for players

with visual disabilities or game adaptations within a single-game environment. For instance, players with visual disabilities utilize technical features such as audio feedback and auditory landmarks to detect occluded objects [15]. They also actively develop strategies, including the creative use of save features or engaging in social play [9]. These studies align with the broader effort to understand how players with disabilities cope with in-game difficulties and develop adaptation strategies. However, existing research has largely been limited to specific disability groups. Our research incorporates the adaptation patterns that emerge across different disability groups.

Additionally, prior research has explored the role of resources in discovering games during the game adoption process [13]. Our research expands on this by examining how players with disabilities iteratively use resources throughout gameplay to adapt to difficulties, including instances where they continue playing and transfer to another game.

2.2 Coping Strategies and Resources of Players with Disabilities in Gameplay

Players with disabilities adopt a range of coping strategies during the exploration, evaluation, and adaptation phases of gameplay. These strategies include modifying playstyles, using assistive tools, and creating personalized approaches to address physical and sensory difficulties. It was also discovered that such adaptive methods depend on various resources categorized as individual, social, cultural, and game environment resources, assets that players rely on to overcome difficulties and achieve their goals [13].

Prior research provides valuable insights into these resources. Beeston and her colleagues (2018) highlighted the importance of individual and game environment resources, such as assistive technologies like adaptive controllers and in-game accessibility features like key remapping and subtitles [4]. Meanwhile, Aguado-Delgado and his colleagues (2020) emphasized game environment resources, noting that customizable interfaces and adaptive difficulty settings are critical to fostering inclusive gameplay [1]. Social resources include community support systems where players collaborate with teammates or engage in online forums to share strategies and solutions, as explored by [4]. Finally, Dumont and Bonenfant (2023) introduced the concept of cultural resources, highlighting how games can promote inclusiveness, diversity, and cultural equity through thoughtful game mechanics and accessibility features [7]. However, questions still remain on whether these resources play an equal role in players' experiences, particularly in influencing their decision to continue playing.

3 Methods

3.1 Interview Process

Participants were recruited from the playtester program run by the accessibility team of a local game company. Five players with disabilities from the player pool consented to participate in the study. To develop individually designed interview questions, an online pre-survey was conducted prior to the interviews. The pre-survey collected participants' demographic information, detailed descriptions of their disabilities, game preferences, accessibility settings used, frequently played games, and the accessibility difficulties they encountered.

Pre-survey responses showed that participants demonstrated characteristics commonly associated with hardcore players. Participants reported an average start age of 10.2 years, playing 21 hours per week, and having experience with over 80 different games. These characteristics align with established definitions of hardcore gamers [12], ensuring that our sample represents individuals with sustained and in-depth engagement in gaming.

Subsequently, two-hour semi-structured interviews were conducted at locations chosen by the participants. During the interviews, participants were asked to describe, in detail, the difficulties they faced when starting a game, adjusting settings, engaging in gameplay, exiting, and how they addressed those difficulties. Additionally, they were asked to report any new difficulties that emerged as they continued to play over extended periods. Interviews were audio-recorded and transcribed with the participants' consent. The study procedures were approved by the Institutional Review Board (IRB) of the authors' affiliated institution. Participant profiles are summarized in Table 1.

3.2 Data Analysis

Interview transcripts were analyzed using the thematic analysis approach, which allowed themes to emerge directly from the data without preconceived categories [5]. All authors initially familiarized themselves with the data by thoroughly reading the transcripts. Both first authors conducted initial coding by breaking down the data into distinct units focused on participants' difficulties, coping strategies, and resources. Preliminary themes were developed from these codes and were refined through discussions among all authors. To ensure validity and reliability, all authors participated in triangulation by iteratively reviewing and cross-checking themes against participant quotes. Through this analysis process, 3 final themes and 10 final subthemes emerged. The relationships between the final themes and subthemes were examined and mapped as Figure 1 and Figure 2.

4 Results

4.1 Adaptation Process of Gameplay

Figure 1 presents the thematic map of the adaptation process of gameplay. This iterative process of trial and error in employing coping strategies and using resources begins with the recognition of gameplay difficulties. This process leads to two potential outcomes: continue playing or transferring to another game. Regardless of the outcomes, this adaptive journey cultivates a deeper understanding of one's own disabilities and enables players to better navigate future difficulties with refined coping strategies.

4.1.1 Theme 1: Difficulties Related to Disabilities for Gameplay. Difficulties related to disabilities for gameplay derive from physical, sensory, or cognitive disabilities, which can hinder actions that are essential in gameplay such as perceiving visual cues, processing auditory information, or executing precise movements. Participants reported difficulties like repetitive inputs and quick reactions, as well as recognizing in-game visual or auditory cues and experiencing communication difficulties in team-based multiplayer games.

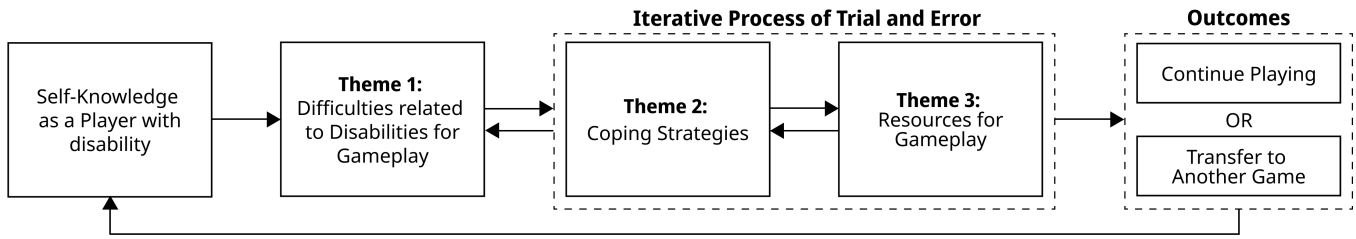


Figure 1: Adaptation Process of Gameplay

"My reaction speed and control speed are slower than other players, so both repetitive inputs and quick inputs are difficult." – P3

"During group combat missions [raids], voice chat through Discord [voice chat program] is commonly used, but I can't hear the communication. Because of this, I don't like playing together with other players." – P4

4.1.2 Theme 2: Coping Strategies. Coping strategies are adaptive methods developed by players with disabilities to address gameplay difficulties. These strategies evolve through trial and error, incorporating learning and refinement. They are categorized into four subthemes: *coming up with personal strategy to play, customizing game settings, using assistive devices and accessibility tools, and developing social gameplay style.*

Participants often incorporated *coming up with personal strategy to play* by practicing repeatedly and learning patterns. Some adopted unique playstyles, such as P5, who prioritized survival and played defensively.

"I just played a lot. Just... played match after match and that's how I [acquired gaming skills]." – P1

"It is like creating your own gameplay style. While others dodge at certain times, I would use a shield and endure. [...] My priority is just staying alive." – P5

Participants employed *customizing game settings* to accommodate their needs. P3 and P5 adjusted controls and dots per inch (DPI) settings, while P1 relied on visual indicators for auditory cues.

"[In League of Legends] They provided a feature that visualizes global attacks [that I cannot hear with sound]. I use [this accessibility feature]. It's extremely helpful." – P1

Using assistive devices and accessibility tools was another effective strategy to adapt to the game. P1 connected hearing aids via Bluetooth to enhance clarity, and P4 adjusted audio settings for better dialogue comprehension.

"When I think 'I want to focus on the story,' I set the volume to maximum, wear hearing aids, and test whether the voice actors' voices are clear." – P4

Lastly, participants developed *social gameplay styles* by collaborating with others. P5 described how friends supported him by providing directions during gameplay.

"My friends help compensate for parts I can't see. For example, they'd say, 'Move to 3 o'clock,' or, 'One square lower.'" – P5

4.1.3 Theme 3: Resources for Gameplay. Resources for gameplay refer to the tools and support systems participants used to develop coping strategies. These resources often led to the discovery of additional resources through an iterative process. Four subthemes emerged: *individual resources, social resources, cultural resources, and game environment resources.*

Individual resources included knowledge and skills acquired through past gaming experiences. These resources helped participants reduce mistakes during the trial and error process. For instance, P3 used a defensive approach in raids by employing a shield to endure damage, while P1 discovered that connecting hearing aids to a PC via Bluetooth minimized noise.

"The noise decreases if I connect my hearing aid to the PC via Bluetooth." – P1

Social resources encompassed guidance and support from others during gameplay. Participants relied on family members who recommended games suited to their preferences and disabilities (P1, P2) and trusted friends who collaborated with them during gameplay (P1, P2, P4, P5). P5's friends described in *developing social gameplay style* subtheme are an example of social resource described by participants.

Cultural resources encompassed inclusive practices, values, and opportunities within the gaming ecosystem that empower and support players with disabilities. These resources extended beyond individual or social interactions to include the broader cultural and professional dimensions of gaming. For example, P1, who works as an accessibility tester at a local game company, exemplifies how gaming can serve as a channel for professional and social participation. P1 valued that he could transform personal experiences into actionable insights for the gaming industry and contribute to improving accessibility in the game industry through his work. This role allowed P1 to deepen his understanding of game accessibility, bridging the gap between personal difficulties and broader cultural advancements.

"[Regarding how I started working as playtester] I clearly saw something similar between work and hobby. That was game accessibility. [...] The barriers I felt, that was exactly what needed to be talked about. So I think this work fits me well. [...] First of all I wanted to play games. I wanted to work while playing games. And that's actually what I'm doing now." – P1

Game environment resources referred to features embedded within the games. These included accessibility settings, such as visual notifications for global sound effects (P1) and key remapping options

(P5). General features that participants used to devise alternative playstyles can also be such resources. For instance, P1 used smart pings for non-verbal communication.

"[I didn't need to communicate through a microphone] because there was smart ping. I would use chat if I needed to explain more." – P1

The availability of game environment resources offered participants flexibility in addressing gameplay difficulties and communicating with others. However, a lack of these resources often forced participants to transfer to different games, as explored in the next subsection.

4.2 Case Studies: Comparing Continue Playing and Transfer to Another Game

Participants faced two different outcomes as they navigated through the difficulties: continue playing or transfer to another game. The results reveal notable differences in the resources accessed and the coping strategies employed during the adaptation process (Figure 2). This section illustrates how variations in resources and strategies influenced players' decisions to persist or switch games by contrasting representative cases from participants' accounts.

4.2.1 Continue Playing: Case of P5. P5's experience with *Lost Ark* demonstrates how players were able to maintain gameplay by developing adaptive strategies with available resources. As P5 progressed to higher levels, he found raids difficult because it required quick reactions to random patterns, which were difficult to discern due to his low vision.

Initially, P5 relied on individual resources, applying skills from previous games and memorizing patterns through repeated attempts. However, as the complexity increased, these efforts proved insufficient. Recognizing the need for additional support, P5 turned to his social resources, his friends. Together, they developed a strategy where his friends provided real-time guidance to compensate for his low vision.

"It was a very complex raid, and I couldn't see the slash marks. (...) My friend gave me directions like 'go to 3 o'clock' and I would go stand there. If I was at the wrong place, they'd say, 'Go one step down.' (...) They helped with the parts I couldn't see due to my disabilities." – P5

This case highlights the importance of combining personal strategies with social support—an effective collaboration can motivate players to continue coping with difficulties they encounter in later gameplay sessions.

4.2.2 Transfer to Another Game: Case of P2. P2's experience illustrates how insufficient game environment resources can hinder adaptation and lead to disengagement. In first-person shooter (FPS) games, P2 struggled with auditory cues essential for locating enemies. He attempted to adapt by predicting movements and customizing settings, but the lack of accessibility features limited his efforts. In *PUBG: Battlegrounds*, the reliance on auditory cues and the large map amplified these difficulties. Despite his attempts, P2 found the game unmanageable and transitioned to *Overwatch*, which offered more flexible playstyles. By focusing on a defensive

tank role, he reached Master rank, leveraging his strengths. However, when attempting roles requiring precise audio processing, he faced recurring difficulties, leading to diminished motivation and eventually disengagement from the FPS genre.

"In FPS games, it's really important to hear and judge where gunshots are coming from. But in PUBG, the map is very large. I couldn't make sense of where gunshots were coming from. (...) [For FPS games], I quit almost all of them except Overwatch. Even there, sound was very important for certain roles, and that discouraged me." – P2

This case underscores the necessity of robust game environment resources. Although P2 tried to adapt using personal strategies and customizing the game environment, the persistent lack of accessible features ultimately led to disengagement.

5 Discussion

This study aimed to understand the difficulties that players with disabilities experience as they continue to play games and how they adapted to such difficulties. From the interviews with five hardcore players with disabilities, we discovered that participants faced difficulties that arose from their disabilities when solving in-game tasks, which is consistent with previous research [16, 20]. Moreover, our findings suggest that participants used diverse resources and developed a broad range of strategies beyond using the available accessibility features. This both aligns with and expands recent findings on the experience of players with disabilities. Our findings not only replicate the finding that supportive relationships and game features play a crucial role in dealing with difficulties [13], but also add that the iterative process of adapting play can involve social efforts (e.g., P5 developing a collaborative strategy in raids).

We also observed that continuing gameplay was not the only outcome; even hardcore, experienced players with disabilities chose to transfer to another game. Consistent with the previous research [13], this occurred when they deemed the difficulty unmanageable with the available resources. Participants' accounts advance this finding by suggesting that these difficulties predominantly stem from the lack of game environment resources, particularly accessibility features. This may suggest that providing richer, more diverse accessibility features can better support players with disabilities in adapting to difficulties, considering that the upward trajectory of developing a more appropriate and efficient adaptation strategy is based on the iterative process of trial and error.

However, it is important to note that simply adding accessibility features may disrupt the core gameplay experience that the players with disabilities themselves desire. Recent discussion on inclusion in games argues for access to desired experiences, including difficulties [17]. Players with disabilities, like those without, seek enjoyment, competition, and stimulation [11]. Our findings further emphasize the importance of player-centered design to implement options that do not disrupt the desired challenge experience [18]. It is important to note the critical role of social and cultural resources in shaping the outcomes of the adaptive process. P5's experience highlights the value of supportive communities, which offer guidance through knowledge sharing and collaboration, echoing prior research [3].

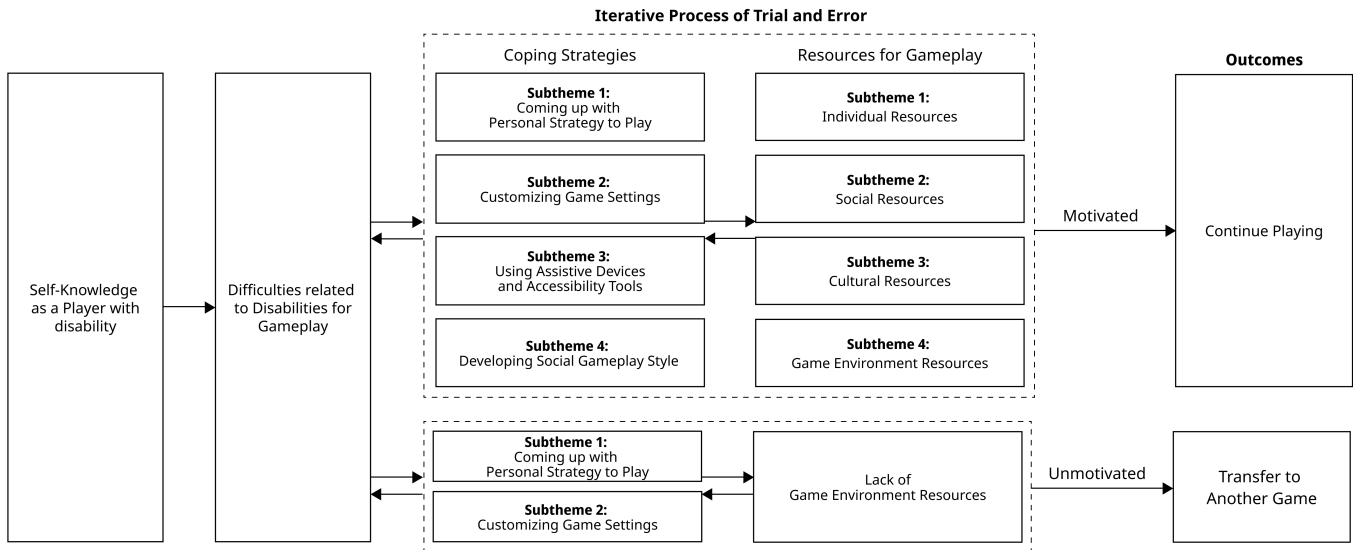


Figure 2: Subthemes and Two Outcomes of the Adaptation Process of Gameplay

Expanding the argument that emphasizes the culture’s role to enhance equitable participation and diverse representation in gaming [7], our results suggest that inclusive practices in game industry and communities, such as accessibility-centered design and community-driven initiatives, can not only help players navigate difficulties but also foster personal growth, social integration, and a sense of belonging. Rather than examining accessible games solely from a functional perspective, our findings also suggest that accessibility adaptations can influence broader social and emotional experiences. Some participants even reported that their engagement in gaming communities contributed to career-related opportunities, which also serve as a pathway for social participation. This was particularly highlighted in our results because all participants played multiplayer genres like MOBA and MMORPG, where players heavily rely on social interactions with player communities as they progress to higher levels. Considering the popularity of multiplayer games in the game industry, we argue that the importance of inclusive communities will grow in the lives of players with disabilities and that fostering such an environment will be crucial to sustaining their adaptation journey.

6 Limitations and Future Works

The study is limited by the small sample size and its focus on hardcore players. Additionally, the current sample is skewed toward participants with hearing disabilities, which may limit the generalizability of the findings to other disability groups. While the findings provide valuable insights into the iterative adaptation process of players with disabilities, they may not fully capture the experiences of individuals with different accessibility needs. Future research should aim to recruit a more diverse sample, including players with different disabilities and gaming backgrounds, especially those who have stopped gaming due to accessibility difficulties. Furthermore, while this study highlights how accessibility adaptations support long-term engagement, it does not measure their broader social and

emotional impact. Although participants described experiences of social integration and career-related opportunities, these accounts are based on self-reports rather than direct assessments. Future research should examine the effects of accessibility adaptations on players’ emotional well-being, social participation, and opportunities beyond gaming.

Building on this study’s findings, we plan to make practical use of these insights in future work, such as developing AI-driven services that help players devise their own coping strategies and enhance available resources to promote sustained engagement for players with disabilities. By exploring these adaptive mechanisms, this study provides foundational knowledge from players’ lived experiences to inform the design of AI-driven accessibility solutions. Insights from hardcore players’ adaptive strategies can guide the development of systems that personalize game settings, recommend accessibility features, and assist players in navigating in-game difficulties.

7 Conclusion

This study explored how players with disabilities navigate difficulties that arise from continued gameplay. Our findings emphasize the crucial role that the iterative process of being aware of available resources and developing adaptive strategies plays in the adaptation process. Participants employed methods such as adjusting game settings, using assistive tools, developing personal strategies, and seeking community support to find ways to adapt and sustain their engagement with the game. However, when game-related resources that enable modification lacked, such as accessibility features, they often lost motivation and switched to other games. These findings highlight that the game-related, social, and cultural resources such as inclusive game features and robust community support play an important role in enabling participants to devise their own coping strategies and continue their gameplay.

Acknowledgments

This work was supported by the National Research Foundation of Korea under the Ministry of Science and ICT (RS-2024-00355534). We also express our gratitude to the participants and Smilegate's Diversity & Inclusion (D&I) department for their support.

References

- [1] J. Aguado-Delgado, J. M. Gutiérrez-Martínez, J. R. Hilera, L. de Marcos, and S. Otón. 2020. Accessibility in Video Games: A Systematic Review. *Universal Access in the Information Society* 19 (2020), 169–193. doi:10.1007/s10209-018-0628-2
- [2] S. L. Anderson and K. Schrier. 2022. Disability and Video Games Journalism: A Discourse Analysis of Accessibility and Gaming Culture. *Games and Culture* 17, 2 (2022), 179–197. doi:10.1177/15554120211021005
- [3] J. Beeston. 2020. *Social experiences of people with disabilities in playing (in)accessible digital games*. Doctoral dissertation. University of York.
- [4] Jen Beeston, Christopher Power, Paul Cairns, and Mark Barlet. 2018. Characteristics and Motivations of Players with Disabilities in Digital Games. arXiv:1805.11352 [cs.HC] <https://arxiv.org/abs/1805.11352>
- [5] Virginia Braun and Victoria Clarke. 2019. Reflecting on Reflexive Thematic Analysis. *Qualitative Research in Sport, Exercise and Health* 11, 4 (2019), 589–597. doi:10.1080/2159676X.2019.1628806
- [6] Paul Cairns, Christopher Power, Mark Barlet, Graham Haynes, Cody Kaufman, and Joseph Beeston. 2021. Enabled Players: The Value of Accessible Digital Games. *Games and Culture* 16, 2 (2021), 262–282. doi:10.1177/1555412019893877
- [7] A. Dumont and M. Bonenfant. 2023. Thinking Inclusiveness, Diversity, and Cultural Equity Based on Game Mechanics and Accessibility Features in Popular Video Games. In *The Palgrave Handbook of Disability and Communication*, M. S. Jeffress, J. M. Cypher, J. Ferris, and J. A. Scott-Pollock (Eds.). Palgrave Macmillan, Cham, 221–242. doi:10.1007/978-3-031-14447-9_14
- [8] Erinn H. Finke, Benjamin D. Hickerson, and Jennifer M. D. Kremkow. 2018. "To Be Quite Honest, If It Wasn't for Videogames I Wouldn't Have a Social Life at All": Motivations of Young Adults With Autism Spectrum Disorder for Playing Videogames as Leisure. *American Journal of Speech-Language Pathology* 27, 2 (May 3 2018), 672–689. doi:10.1044/2017_AJSLP-17-0073
- [9] David Gonçalves, Manuel Piçarra, Pedro Pais, Jo ao Guerreiro, and André Rodrigues. 2023. "My Zelda Cane": Strategies Used by Blind Players to Play Visual-Centric Digital Games. In *Proceedings of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (Hamburg, Germany) (CHI '23). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 289, 15 pages. doi:10.1145/3544548.3580702
- [10] Lena Hassan. 2024. Accessibility of Games and Game-Based Applications: A Systematic Literature Review and Mapping of Future Directions. *New Media & Society* 26, 4 (2024), 2336–2384. doi:10.1177/14614448231204020
- [11] Catherine Holloway, Kathrin Gerling, Christopher Power, Katta Spiel, Giulia Barbareschi, Anna Cox, and Paul Cairns. 2019. Disability Interactions in Digital Games: From Accessibility to Inclusion. In *Extended Abstracts of the Annual Symposium on Computer-Human Interaction in Play Companion Extended Abstracts* (Barcelona, Spain) (CHI PLAY '19 Extended Abstracts). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 835–839. doi:10.1145/3341215.3349587
- [12] Jesper Juul. 2012. *A Casual Revolution: Reinventing Video Games and Their Players*. MIT Press, Cambridge, MA, USA.
- [13] Jesse J. Martinez, Jon E. Froehlich, and James Fogarty. 2024. Playing on Hard Mode: Accessibility, Difficulty and Joy in Video Game Adoption for Gamers with Disabilities. In *Proceedings of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (Honolulu, HI, USA) (CHI '24). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 524, 17 pages. doi:10.1145/3613904.3642804
- [14] Daniel Muriel and Garry Crawford. 2018. *Video Games as Culture: Considering the Role and Importance of Video Games in Contemporary Society*. Routledge. doi:10.4324/9781315622743
- [15] Manuel Piçarra, André Rodrigues, and Jo ao Guerreiro. 2023. Evaluating Accessible Navigation for Blind People in Virtual Environments. In *Extended Abstracts of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (Hamburg, Germany) (CHI EA '23). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 105, 7 pages. doi:10.1145/3544549.3585813
- [16] John R. Porter and Julie A. Kientz. 2013. An Empirical Study of Issues and Barriers to Mainstream Video Game Accessibility. In *Proceedings of the 15th International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility* (Bellevue, Washington) (ASSETS '13). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 3, 8 pages. doi:10.1145/2513383.2513444
- [17] Christopher Power, Paul Cairns, and Mark Barlet. 2018. *New directions in third wave human-computer interaction: Volume 1 - Technologies*. Human-Computer Interaction Series, Vol. 1. Springer International Publishing, Cham, Chapter Inclusion in the third wave: Access to experience, 163–181. doi:10.1007/978-3-319-73356-2_10
- [18] Christopher Power, Paul Cairns, Mark Barlet, Gregory Haynes, Jen Beeston, and Triskal DeHaven. 2021. Validation and prioritization of design options for accessible player experiences. *Interacting with Computers* 33, 6 (2021), 641–656. doi:10.1093/iwc/iwac017
- [19] M. Schmierbach, R. Tan, and B. Sherrick. 2024. Difficulty and challenge in video games. In *Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Communication*. Oxford University Press. <https://doi.org/10.1093/acrefore/9780190228613.013.1471>
- [20] Bei Yuan, Eelke Folmer, and Frederick C. Harris. 2011. Game Accessibility: A Survey. *Universal Access in the Information Society* 10, 1 (March 2011), 81–100. doi:10.1007/s10209-010-0189-5